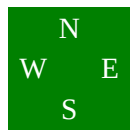


Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K J 8 4
♥ 10 9 4 2
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ 5

♠ Q 3
♥ K Q 5
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ Q J 7 4



♠ 10 9 6 2
♥ 8 7 6
♦ 7 3
♣ A K 8 2

♠ A 7 5
♥ A J 3
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 6 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♣
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			
3NT by North			

The chance of ♦s splitting 3-3 is about 40%.

So you should enter dummy with a ♥ and play a small ♠ toward your ♠Q.

Did it work?

You might have thought of another possibility; duck a ♦, then play ♦A and ♦K to see if the ♦s split before you try leading toward the ♠Q.

The problem is that you might run into this very distribution. You would establish a ♦ for West and when you played a ♠ from dummy West would jump up with the ♠K and cash his winning ♦ for down 1.

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. West follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

East leads the ♣A, then ♣K, ♣2. West follows once, then discards a ♠ and a ♥.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=3 ♦=2 ♣=2 Total = 8

There are two possibilities for getting an extra winner. If the ♦s are splitting 3-3 you could play ♦A, ♦K and another ♦ and establish the thirteenth ♦ as a winner. Or you could play West for the ♠K and lead toward your ♠Q.

The chance of West holding the ♠K is a little greater than 50%. (it is higher than the usual 50% because we know he started with only one ♣, giving him more spaces for other cards).

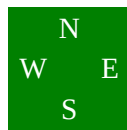
Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 4 2
♥ A 8 5
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 6 5

♠ 10 8 7 6
♥ 10 6 4 2
♦ 8 2
♣ 10 7 3



♠ A Q 5
♥ K J 9
♦ A 10 4
♣ Q J 9 2

♠ K J 3
♥ Q 7 3
♦ K Q J 9 5
♣ 8 4

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	Pass	1NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			
♣s ending in your hand.			

East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♦ K.

Winners: ♠=1 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=4 Total = 8

You only need one more winner. If North has the ♠ K or the ♥ Q a simple finesse will give you the trick.

There are two problems though. The first one is that if South gets in he may take too many ♦ tricks. But the bigger problem is that North cannot possibly have either of those two high cards. You and dummy together hold 28 HCP and South must surely hold the other 12 since he opened the bidding. Neither simple finesse will work so you must try what is called a Backward Finesse.

Hold up the ♦ A until the third round to confirm that North has only 2. He does. Then play four rounds of

Now play the ♥ J. If South doesn't cover, you will let it ride for your ninth trick. But South does cover so you must take dummy's ♥ A. Next play a small ♥ from dummy and finesse the ♥ 9, hoping North has the ♥ 10. This is the Backward Finesse.

The Backward Finesse is a pretty rare play. It is against the odds so you only try it when you are absolutely certain that a normal finesse is doomed to fail.

Like this time.

By the way. Those of you with great short-term memories might think they have seen this hand before. Well, you ALMOST have. Deal 8 has an almost identical layout but a much simpler theme. Check it out.